

Senior Year Timeline

FILL IN TOGETHER

Every month of senior year and what must happen in it. Stick it where both of you walk past it.

When: Print in August before senior year and keep it visible

August and September

- ☐ Finalise the college list — balanced, and affordable
- ☐ Open the Common App and complete the profile sections
- ☐ Finish the personal statement
- ☐ Confirm both teacher recommendations in writing
- ☐ Request transcripts through the counselling office
- ☐ Note every Early Action and Early Decision deadline
- ☐ Take the last SAT or ACT if you are still improving

October and November

- ☐ File the FAFSA as soon as it opens
- ☐ File the CSS Profile if any school on the list requires it
- ☐ Submit Early Action / Early Decision applications
- ☐ Write the supplemental essays school by school
- ☐ Apply to at least five scholarships
- ☐ Check every portal for missing items — do not assume

December to February

- ☐ Submit all remaining applications well before the deadline
- ☐ Early results arrive — respond to any binding offer properly
- ☐ Keep the grades up; offers are conditional on the final transcript
- ☐ Send mid-year reports where required
- ☐ Keep applying for scholarships — the local ones are still open

March to May

- ☐ Decisions and award letters arrive — compare on net price
- ☐ Appeal an award if circumstances have genuinely changed
- ☐ Revisit the top two if you can
- ☐ Decide and deposit by 1 May
- ☐ Tell the other colleges no, so a place opens for someone else
- ☐ Take AP or IB exams

Summer

- ☐ Send the final transcript
- ☐ Complete housing, health forms and immunisation records
- ☐ Attend orientation and register for classes
- ☐ Set up the tuition payment plan
- ☐ Sign the FERPA release if you have agreed to it

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ 1 May is the national deposit deadline. Almost nothing moves it.
- ◆ Offers are conditional. A collapsed final term can and does get them withdrawn.
- ◆ Declining the offers you will not take is a kindness that costs nothing.